FRANMARINE UNDERWATER SERVICES PTY LTD

NAVIGATION AND WATCHKEEPING

Procedure

MV SEAGULL | UVI: 425689

Marine Order 504 (2024) — Schedule 1 Compliance

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Review Frequency

This document shall be reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner following a significant incident, change of operations, vessel modification, or change in applicable legislation.

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes the navigation, lookout, COLREGs compliance, passage planning, and watchkeeping requirements for MV Seagull.

1.1 Regulatory Reference

Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5). International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea, 1972 (COLREGs). Marine Order 30 (Prevention of Collisions). NSCV C7C (Navigation Equipment). NSW Marine Safety Act 1998 and Marine Safety Regulation 2016.

2. LOOKOUT

The master shall ensure a proper lookout is maintained at all times by sight and hearing as well as by all available means appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions, so as to make a full appraisal of the situation and the risk of collision (COLREGs Rule 5).

- A dedicated lookout shall be posted whenever the master's attention is significantly occupied by other duties (e.g. managing diving operations, navigating in congested waters).
- Electronic aids (chart plotter, echo sounder, GNSS) supplement but do not replace visual and auditory lookout.

3. SAFE SPEED

The vessel shall at all times proceed at a safe speed so that proper and effective action can be taken to avoid collision and the vessel can be stopped within a distance appropriate to the prevailing circumstances (COLREGs Rule 6). Factors to consider include:

- State of visibility.
- Traffic density.
- Manoeuvrability of the vessel including stopping distance.
- Background light at night.
- Wind, sea state, and current.
- Depth of water (monitored via the echo sounder).

4. COLLISION AVOIDANCE

4.1 Risk of Collision

All available means shall be used to determine if risk of collision exists. If there is any doubt, risk shall be deemed to exist (COLREGs Rule 7). A steady compass bearing to an approaching vessel that does not change appreciably indicates risk of collision.

4.2 Action to Avoid Collision

Any action to avoid collision shall be positive, made in ample time, and large enough to be readily apparent to another vessel (COLREGs Rule 8). A succession of small alterations of course or speed shall be avoided.

4.3 Head-On Situation

When two power-driven vessels are meeting head-on or nearly head-on, each shall alter course to starboard so that each passes on the port side of the other (COLREGs Rule 14).

4.4 Crossing Situation

When two power-driven vessels are crossing so as to involve risk of collision, the vessel which has the other on her starboard side shall keep out of the way and shall avoid crossing ahead of the other vessel (COLREGs Rule 15).

4.5 Overtaking

Any vessel overtaking another shall keep out of the way of the vessel being overtaken (COLREGs Rule 13). A vessel is overtaking when coming up from more than 22.5 degrees abaft the beam of the other vessel.

4.6 Responsibilities Between Vessels

A power-driven vessel underway shall keep out of the way of (COLREGs Rule 18):

- A vessel not under command.
- A vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre (including vessels engaged in diving or underwater operations).
- A vessel engaged in fishing.
- A sailing vessel.
- A vessel under escort and its escort vessel(s) — keep well clear and never pass between a vessel under escort and its escort.

5. NAVIGATION LIGHTS AND SHAPES

MV Seagull is a power-driven vessel less than 12 metres in length. The following lights shall be displayed (COLREGs Rules 22 and 23, Marine Order 30):

- Masthead light — visible 2 nautical miles.
- Sidelights (red port, green starboard) — visible 1 nautical mile. May be combined in one lantern for vessels <20 m.
- Sternlight — visible 2 nautical miles.

Note: COLREGs Rule 23(c) permits a power-driven vessel of less than 7 metres in length whose maximum speed does not exceed 7 knots to exhibit an all-round white light in lieu of the above lights. This exemption does not apply to MV Seagull.

When MV Seagull is engaged in diving operations and restricted in her ability to manoeuvre (COLREGs Rule 27):

- Three all-round lights in a vertical line: red, white, red (highest and lowest red, middle white).
- By day: three shapes in a vertical line — ball, diamond, ball.
- A rigid replica of the International Code flag 'A' (Alpha flag) not less than 1 metre in height shall be exhibited when diving operations make it impracticable to display full shapes (Rule 27(e)).
- Two all-round green lights or two diamonds in a vertical line on the side on which another vessel may pass (Rule 27(d)(ii)).
- Two all-round red lights or two balls in a vertical line on the side on which an obstruction exists (Rule 27(d)(i)).

6. SOUND SIGNALS

As a vessel less than 12 metres LOA, MV Seagull is required to carry a sound signal (not a whistle — the whistle requirement applies to vessels ≥12 m LOA). The vessel shall be provided with a means of making an efficient sound signal (COLREGs Rule 33(b), NSCV C7C). The following signals shall be understood and used:

- One short blast (≈1 second) — altering course to starboard.
- Two short blasts — altering course to port.
- Three short blasts — operating astern propulsion.
- Five or more short and rapid blasts — warning / doubt signal.
- One prolonged blast (4–6 seconds) — approaching a blind bend in a narrow channel.

7. SYDNEY HARBOUR AND NSW WATERWAY RULES

When operating on Sydney Harbour and NSW coastal waters, the following additional rules apply:

7.1 VHF Channels

Maintain the continuous watch on VHF Ch 16 and monitor Sydney VTS on VHF Ch 13 throughout. Use VHF Ch 14 for defence tower approvals and the Marine Rescue NSW unit working channels for position reports.

7.2 Ferries

Avoid ferry lanes wherever possible and never cross directly in front of a ferry.

Give way to all ferries, including Manly ferries, RiverCat and inner-harbour services.

If a ferry sounds a VHF safety message or displays flashing yellow lights, slow down and give way immediately.

Ferries showing an orange diamond shape carry the 'priority over sail signal': by day, sailing vessels must keep well clear of them (200 m from the bow, 30 m from the sides or stern); this does not apply at night or when the ferry is overtaking. High-speed ferries show an all-round yellow flashing light and may be travelling faster than they appear. Keep clear of all ferries and give way under the general rules.

7.3 Commercial Shipping

Monitor Sydney VTS on VHF Ch 13 for commercial shipping; large vessels in the main channel cannot stop or manoeuvre quickly and must be given a wide berth.

Do not anchor in, or obstruct, the main shipping channel or fairway.

Keep well clear of escort tugs and pilot vessels engaged with a ship under way.

7.4 Defence Waters

All vessel movements within defence precinct waters shall be approved by the appropriate tower (Garden Island Tower or Waterhen Tower) on VHF Ch 14 before proceeding.

Observe all exclusion zones and restricted areas, and comply with all directions from defence port control.

Do not approach, photograph, or loiter near naval vessels without authorisation.

7.5 Speed Limits

Maximum 15 knots in the Bridge Transit Zone (no anchoring or drifting there); maximum 6 knots within 30 metres of any other vessel.

Comply with all posted speed signs and restricted-area markers.

7.6 Circular Quay and Shipyards

When entering Circular Quay or approaching a shipyard, contact Sydney VTS on VHF Ch 13 to advise of intended movements and obtain approval.

7.7 Seaplanes

Regular seaplane operations occur out of Rose Bay — watch for aircraft on approach and departure and give the landing area a wide berth.

Channel	Usage
VHF Ch 16	International distress, safety, and calling channel. Continuous

	listening watch required.
VHF Ch 13	Sydney VTS (Port Jackson) — commercial shipping movements and harbour traffic.
12	Botany Bay VTS — Botany Bay traffic information and vessel movements.
VHF Ch 14	Defence port operations — Garden Island Tower / Waterhen Tower.
VHF Ch 12 / 67 / 73	Botany Bay VTS; Marine Rescue NSW (Sydney / Botany Bay).

8. PASSAGE PLANNING

For the full passage planning procedure, refer to FUS-SMS-SGL-05K Passage Planning.
Before each voyage the master shall plan the passage, considering:

- Weather forecast and sea conditions (Bureau of Meteorology marine forecast).
- Tidal conditions and predicted tidal streams.
- Known hazards, restricted areas, defence exclusion zones, and traffic separation schemes.
- Fuel requirements (voyage fuel plus 30% reserve minimum).
- Expected time of departure and arrival.
- Nominated safe havens or ports of refuge along the route.
- Communication schedule and reporting requirements.
- VTS reporting requirements for the operational area (Sydney VTS VHF Ch 13).
- Coastal bar conditions if applicable (check bar cameras, swell forecasts, and tide times).

The passage plan shall be communicated to all crew before departure.

9. RESTRICTED VISIBILITY

In conditions of restricted visibility (fog, heavy rain, spray), the master shall (COLREGs Rule 19):

- Reduce speed to a safe speed adapted to the conditions.
- Have the engine ready for immediate manoeuvre.
- Sound appropriate fog signals at intervals of not more than 2 minutes (one prolonged blast for a power-driven vessel making way through the water).
- Use chart plotter, echo sounder, and GNSS to maintain situational awareness.
- Avoid altering course to port for a vessel forward of the beam.

10. RECORDS

Navigation details including departure and arrival times, route taken, weather conditions, and any incidents are recorded in the vessel logbook.

11. REFERENCES

- International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea, 1972 (COLREGs)
- Marine Order 30 (Prevention of Collisions)
- Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5)
- NSCV C7C (Navigation Equipment)
- AMSA Guidance Notice P200608 — NSCV C7 Class 2D Equipment Guide
- NSW Marine Safety Act 1998
- NSW Marine Safety Regulation 2016
- NSW Government — Rules for Boating on Sydney Harbour
- Port Authority of NSW — Harbour Master Directions
- FUS-SMS-SGL-05J Radio Watch